ATLAS

College of Engineering & Applied Science
UNIVERSITY OF COLORADO BOULDER

Funded PhD Positions at the ATLAS Institute, University of Colorado Boulder

We invite applications for fully-funded PhD positions at the ATLAS Institute, University of Colorado Boulder. Our Creative Technology & Design PhD program emphasizes radical inquiry and invention, and is suited to students whose interests transcend traditional disciplinary boundaries. Degrees are conferred by the College of Engineering & Applied Science.

ATLAS labs work across an intentionally eclectic set of disciplines, bound by a thriving academic community of researchers and students who believe that integrating design, art, and engineering is the best way to identify and address real-world challenges.

The following labs are recruiting students for Fall 2027:

- **The Unstable Design Lab**, led by Professor Laura Devendorf, seeks PhD students to research topics in computational design in the domain of textiles; open source community development; documentation and instructional formats; and/or research developing woven structures to support the integration of electronic and/or bio-materials. These positions aim to support new grants in open source and reproducible woven textile technologies. The lab works at the intersection between engineering and craft to explore the possibilities textiles have to impact scientific discovery while also supporting creative practice.
- **The Utility Research Lab**, directed by Professor Michael Rivera, seeks two highly-motivated PhD students to research topics in digital fabrication and sustainability. The lab invents and investigates digital manufacturing technology by combining computational fabrication, materials science, and sustainable design practices. The goal is to advance science and engineering while positively impacting people, society, and the environment.
- **The Brain Music Lab**, directed by Professor Grace Leslie, seeks PhD students to research and develop creative practices to promote health and well-being by combining new music technologies with EEG (brainwave data) and other physiological measurement techniques.
- **The ACME Lab**, directed by Professor Ellen Yi-Luen, Do is accepting PhD applications. The lab researches computational tools at the intersection of design, creativity, cognition, tangible/embedded interaction, and computing for health and wellness. The lab operates on the core belief that everyone can be creative because everyone has the ability to make things. Researchers build physical, digital, and interactive models and machines to explain & augment human intelligence, design, and physical collaboration.

- **The WILDD Systems Lab** (Ways of Interpreting Landscape Disturbance + Dynamics), directed by Professor Megan Cattau, is accepting PhD applications to develop interactive and immersive systems for investigating environmental change and supporting wildfire and land-management decisions through participatory processes. The lab brings together disturbance ecology, geospatial data and remote sensing, and creative technologies to develop new ways of understanding environmental change and how it is experienced. The goal is to broaden how scientists, managers, and communities contribute knowledge and perspectives to environmental research and decision-making.

Interested? Here are your first steps:

- Register for our online info session on October 8 at 8:30am MT
- Explore our PhD webpages and sign up for our email list
- Reach out directly to the directors of the labs you are most interested in (see their lab pages for contact information)

Applications due: December 1, 2026

Questions? Email atlas.admissions@colorado.edu

About University of Colorado Boulder (CU Boulder)

CU Boulder is Colorado's flagship university serving a global community of students, educators, researchers, creatives and thought leaders. Our graduate programs produce ground-breaking research, economic growth and meaningful impact across many fields. And according to U.S. News and World Report's Best Graduate Schools rankings for 2026-27, CU Boulder's engineering programs are in the top 10 among public universities in the U.S.

Named one of the healthiest cities in America, Boulder boasts easy access to nature, eclectic cultural and outdoor activities, and a thriving entrepreneurial scene.